



Protect your data

documentation, community forums, FAQs, help files and beyond. They also should provide free telephone, email and chat support via a helpful and knowledgeable support team. The top internet security selections provide support during extended support hours, continuous software updates and timely threat information.

How to test different internet security software suites?

On any given day, one vendor may be a little quicker on the draw to prevent a virus than others. That makes evaluating the strength of a particular anti-malware or anti-spam product very difficult. You can test each security suite based upon factors that affect you directly:

- ▶ Ease of installation
- ▶ Ease of use
- ▶ Notification capabilities
- ▶ Updating time
- ▶ Quality of the interface

When you're testing new software suites, you should check how long the machines take to boot up, once you have successfully installed the software product on your notebook. You can then compare that figure to the time it had taken the machine to boot up without a security suite installed. After each test, you can restore the notebook back to its pretesting condition using any "Backup & Recovery Suite" – this ensures that each product is installed under the exact same conditions, with the same software configuration. During testing, you should also keep a lookout for tell-tale signs of poor performance, such as high processor utilisation and slow system boots. Another important thing to keep in mind is the overall responsiveness of the interface. Finally, beware of the suites which are overly intrusive and get in the way of effectively using your PC by, for example, bombarding you with messages and warnings.